

C2_05 Gate A Protected Review - Astra RC4

Retail Orders. Open only after a saved genuine Gate A attempt.

1. Objective fixture controls

Control	Expected	Why it matters
Approved scope	2 approved order files; 90 rows	Filename discovery must not accidentally include the malformed September file.
Master key	17 master rows / 16 unique; duplicate C005	Duplicate must block enrichment before merge.
Unmatched key	C999 on 1 order; sales 1,855.67	LEFT/indicator evidence keeps the exception visible.
Approved sales	115,976.44 total	Independent total before enrichment is a release control.
Duplicate fan-out	C005 appears on 6 orders; naive merge -> 96 rows / 122,135.78	Inflation equals 6,159.34; a plausible higher total is still wrong.
Date evidence	July 51 rows / 56,470.38; August 39 / 59,506.06	File name and actual order_date month are not identical scopes.
Channel split	store 38,827.08; partner 38,661.17; web 38,488.19	Useful independent business controls after parsing.

2. Expected reasoning path

Declare expected file set before discovery; malformed file is rejected/quarantined with evidence rather than silently coerced.

Validate customer master uniqueness before merge. C005 duplicate is a critical block; do not drop one row merely to make the merge run.

Preserve C999 as unmatched evidence. A left merge with indicator/cardinality checks is safer than hiding the exception.

Reconcile 90 approved order rows and 115,976.44 sales before and after enrichment. A naive duplicate-key merge would create 96 rows and 122,135.78 sales.

Logs/validation explain the block; final output is written only after critical PASS. Re-run the same approved inputs and prove no duplicate business result.

3. Critical failures

- Uncontrolled glob includes the malformed file.
- to_datetime/to_numeric coercion silently discards the bad row without a documented decision.
- Duplicate C005 is silently dropped or many-to-many merge is accepted.
- C999 disappears in an inner merge.
- Output is published before row/sales/key checks pass.
- Second run appends duplicate business rows.
- No manifest of Python/pandas, inputs, checks and output.

4. Competency floors

Competency	Required proof
Clean start / modularity	Explicit config/entry point; functions have coherent responsibilities and can be tested independently.
File/schema/key controls	Approved file scope, schema/types, master uniqueness, merge cardinality and unmatched evidence are explicit.
Reconciliation / release gate	Rows and key numeric controls reconcile; critical FAIL withholds final output.
Errors / observability	Specific failures carry context; logs + structured validation show stage and observed value.
Rerun / reproducibility	Unchanged rerun does not duplicate business results; run manifest records environment, inputs and outputs.

Changed repair proof

This protected review opens only after a saved genuine Gate A attempt. Close it, complete a changed fresh retry using new retail files/keys while proving file scope, uniqueness, unmatched evidence, reconciliation, release gate and rerun safety. Save the retry evidence. Gate B is a different Support Tickets reassessment and opens only when explicitly assigned after repair.